Which medical plan is right for you?

2026 QUICK-REFERENCE GUIDE



Employee Medical Plan Costs

UC will continue to pay the greater portion of monthly medical plan premiums in 2026, and employees will pay the balance as shown in the tables.

Four Rate Levels Based on Salary

Four rate tables ("pay bands") are shown here. Your pay band, and thus your premium, is based on your full-time salary rate as of January 1, 2025. UC provides larger monthly employer contributions for those earning less to help keep premium costs from becoming a burden.

Retiree Medical Plan Costs

Retirees can find their monthly premiums for the medical plans listed here online at ucal.us/retireepremiums

FOR THOSE WITH FULL-TIME SALARY RATE OF $73,000 OR LESS

PLAN	Self	Self plus child(ren)	Self plus adult	Self plus adult and child(ren)
HealthSavings+ (PPO)	$23.41	$42.14	$177.46	$196.18
Kaiser Permanente – CA (HMO)	$75.57	$136.02	$257.78	$318.23
UC Blue & Gold HMO	$97.97	$176.35	$334.04	$412.42
UC Care (PPO)	$130.85	$235.52	$403.08	$507.76

FOR THOSE WITH FULL-TIME SALARY RATE OF $73,001 TO $145,000

PLAN	Self	Self plus child(ren)	Self plus adult	Self plus adult and child(ren)
HealthSavings+ (PPO)	$81.73	$147.12	$290.31	$355.69
Kaiser Permanente – CA (HMO)	$120.61	$217.09	$352.35	$448.83
UC Blue & Gold HMO	$156.29	$281.33	$456.51	$581.55
UC Care (PPO)	$189.17	$340.50	$525.55	$676.89

FOR THOSE WITH FULL-TIME SALARY RATE OF $145,001 TO $217,000

PLAN	Self	Self plus child(ren)	Self plus adult	Self plus adult and child(ren)
HealthSavings+ (PPO)	$140.05	$252.09	$393.19	$505.22
Kaiser Permanente – CA (HMO)	$165.64	$298.15	$446.92	$579.43
UC Blue & Gold HMO	$214.61	$386.30	$578.98	$750.67
UC Care (PPO)	$247.49	$445.47	$648.02	$846.01

FOR THOSE WITH FULL-TIME SALARY RATE OF OVER $217,000

PLAN	Self	Self plus child(ren)	Self plus adult	Self plus adult and child(ren)
HealthSavings+ (PPO)	$189.61	$341.30	$487.31	$638.99
Kaiser Permanente – CA (HMO)	$210.68	$379.22	$541.50	$710.04
UC Blue & Gold HMO	$272.92	$491.27	$701.44	$919.79
UC Care (PPO)	$305.80	$550.44	$770.48	$1,015.13

Need help choosing a plan? Ask Alex!

ALEX shows rates specific to union membership and location

DEFINITIONS

CALENDAR YEAR DEDUCTIBLE

The amount you must pay for medical services before the plan will provide benefits.

ANNUAL OUT-OF-POCKET MAXIMUM

The amount you must pay during the calendar year before the plan will pay 100% of covered charges. Some expenses do not apply toward the maximum; see the plan's Summary Plan Description (SPD) or Benefit Booklet.

COPAYMENTS

Shown in dollars; represents the amount you pay.

COINSURANCE

Shown as a percentage; represents the percentage of the allowable amount you pay.

ALLOWABLE AMOUNT

The dollar amount considered payment-in-full for services provided by the health plan carrier's network of healthcare providers. (Out-of-network providers may bill members for amounts in excess of the allowable amount.)

[1] UC Care deductible and out-of-pocket maximums do not cross-accumulate for in-network and out-of-network services. The UC Select and Blue Shield out-of-pocket maximum do cross-accumulate.

[2] In-network expenses count toward meeting the out-of-network deductible, but out-of-network expenses do not count toward meeting the in-network deductible (except for authorized ambulance and emergency medical services).

[3] This assumes you are covered January 1, 2026. If you enroll later in the year, the UC contribution is prorated.

[4] The annual out-of-pocket maximum combines medical, behavioral health, and prescription drugs. Kaiser and Optum do not coordinate costs for behavioral health.

Medical Benefits Summary: 2026

(Non-Medicare)

PLAN	COSTS		
	Calendar Year Deductible	**Health Savings Account (HSA)** (UC Contribution)	**Annual Out-of-Pocket Maximum[4]**
UC Blue & Gold HMO (HMO) 1-800-539-4072	$0	Plan not eligible for HSA but eligible for FSA	Individual: $1,000 Family (3 persons or more): $3,000
Kaiser—CA (HMO) 1-800-464-4000 1-800-324-9208 (Prospective Members)	$0	Plan not eligible for HSA but eligible for FSA	Individual: $1,500 Family (2 persons or more): $3,000
UC Care Tier 1 **In-Network: UC Select** (PPO) 1-866-406-1182	$0	Plan not eligible for HSA but eligible for FSA	Individual: $6,100[1] Family: $9,700[1]
UC Care Tier 2 **In-Network: Blue Shield** (PPO) 1-866-406-1182	Individual: $500[1] Family: $1,000[1]	Plan not eligible for HSA but eligible for FSA	Individual: $7,600[1] Family: $14,200[1]
UC Care Tier 3 **Out-of-Network** (PPO) 1-866-406-1182	Individual: $750[1] Family: $1,750[1]	Plan not eligible for HSA but eligible for FSA	Individual: $9,600[1] Family: $20,200[1]
HealthSavings+ **In-Network** (PPO) 1-866-406-1182	Individual Coverage: $2,500[2] Family Coverage: $5,000[2] (You may use your HSA funds to pay for your deductible and other eligible out-of-pocket expenses.)	Employee: up to $750[3] Employee & Adult: up to $1,500[3] Employee & Children: up to $1,500[3] Family: up to $1,500[3]	Individual Coverage: $6,700 Family Coverage: $13,400
HealthSavings+ **Out-of-Network** (PPO) 1-866-406-1182	Individual Coverage: $4,000[2] Family Coverage: $8,000[2] (You may use your HSA funds to pay for your deductible and other eligible out-of-pocket expenses.)	Employee: up to $750[3] Employee & Adult: up to $1,500[3] Employee & Children: up to $1,500[3] Family: up to $1,500[3]	Individual Coverage: $8,000 Family Coverage: $16,000

Medical Benefits Summary: 2026

(Non-Medicare)

PLAN	HOSPITAL SERVICES					PHYSICIAN VISITS					
	Inpatient	**Surgeon/ Assistant Surgeon**	**Emergency Room**	**Ambulance**	**Urgent Care**	**Office Visit**	**Hospital Visit**	**Preventive Physical Exam**	**Maternity Outpatient Care**	**Maternity Inpatient Care**	**Well Baby Care**
UC Blue & Gold HMO (HMO)	$250 copayment per admittance	No charge	$125 (waived if admitted)	No charge	$30	$30	No charge	No charge	No charge	$250 copayment per admittance	No charge
Kaiser—CA (HMO)	$250 copayment per admittance	No charge	$125 (waived if admitted)	No charge	$30	$30	No charge	No charge	No charge	$250 copayment per admittance	No charge
UC Care Tier 1 In-Network: UC Select (PPO)	$250 copayment	No charge	Facility: $300 copay per visit not resulting in admission, $250 if admitted ER Physician Services: No charge (not subject to calendar year deductible)	N/A (services covered under Tier 2 - Blue Shield PPO)	$30	$30	No charge	No charge	$30 (initial visit only)	$250 copayment per admittance	No charge
UC Care Tier 2 In-Network: Blue Shield (PPO)	30%	30%	Facility: $300 copay per visit not resulting in admission, $250 if admitted ER Physician Services: No charge (not subject to calendar year deductible)	$200/trip (not subject to calendar year deductible)	$30 (not subject to calendar year deductible)	30%	30%	No charge (not subject to calendar year deductible)	30%	30%	No charge (not subject to calendar year deductible)
UC Care Out-of-Network (PPO)	50% (non-preferred hospitals subject to maximum payment of $300/day)	50%	Facility: $300 copay per visit not resulting in admission, $250 if admitted ER Physician Services: No charge (not subject to calendar year deductible)	$200/trip (not subject to calendar year deductible)	50%	50%	50%	50%[11]	50%[11]	50% (non-preferred hospitals subject to maximum payment of $300/day)	50%
HealthSavings+ In-Network (PPO)	30%	30%	30%	30%	30% after deductible	30%	30%	No charge (not subject to calendar year deductible)	30%	30%	No charge (not subject to calendar year deductible)
HealthSavings+ Out-of-Network (PPO)	50% (out-of-network hospitals subject to maximum payment of $360/day)	50%	50%	50%	50% after deductible	50%	50%	50%[11]	50%	50% (out-of-network hospitals subject to maximum payment of $360/day)	50%

OTHER BENEFITS							PRESCRIPTION DRUGS	
Hospice Inpatient and Outpatient	**Home Health Care**	**Skilled Nursing Facility**	**Outpatient X-Ray and Lab**	**Eye Exams**	**Chiropractor**	**Acupuncture**	**Retail** (Up to 30-day supply)	**Mail Order** (Up to 90-day supply)
No charge	No charge	No charge (up to 100 days/ calendar year)	No charge	$30 (no charge if part of a preventive care exam)	$20 (24-visit limit/calendar year combined with acupuncture)	$20 (24-visit limit/calendar year combined with chiropractor)	Generic: $10[9] Brand: $30[5, 9] Non-Formulary: $50[5, 9] Specialty Drug: 30% up to $150 max per prescription	Generic: $20 Brand: $60[5] Specialty: N/A Non-Formulary: $100[5]
No charge	No charge (up to 100 visits/calendar year)	No charge (up to 100 days/ calendar year)	No charge	No charge if part of a routine physical exam	$15 (24-visit limit/calendar year combined with acupuncture)	$15 (24-visit limit/calendar year combined with chiropractor)	Generic: $10 Preferred Brand: $30 Non-preferred Brand: $30 Specialty: 30% coinsurance up to $150 per prescription	Up to a 100-day supply Generic: $20 Preferred Brand: $60 Non-preferred Brand: $60 Specialty: availability varies
N/A (services covered under Tier 2 - Blue Shield PPO)	N/A (services covered under Tier 2 - Blue Shield PPO)	N/A (services covered under Tier 2 - Blue Shield PPO)	$30	No charge if part of a routine physical exam, otherwise $30	N/A (services covered under Tier 2 - Blue Shield PPO)	N/A (services covered under Tier 2 - Blue Shield PPO)	At Navitus network pharmacies: Tier 1: $10[6, 7, 9] Tier 2: $30[6, 7, 9] Tier 3: $50[6, 7, 9]	Tier 1: $20[6, 7] Tier 2: $60[6, 7] Tier 3: $100[6, 7]
30%	30% (up to 100 visits/ calendar year)	30% (up to 100 days/ calendar year)	30%	No charge if part of a routine physical exam, otherwise 30%	30% (preferred providers and 24-visit limit/ calendar year combined with acupuncture)	30% (preferred providers and 24-visit limit/ calendar year combined with chiropractor)	At Navitus network pharmacies: Tier 1: $10[6, 7, 9] Tier 2: $30[6, 7, 9] Tier 3: $50[6, 7, 9]	Tier 1: $20[6, 7] Tier 2: $60[6, 7] Tier 3: $100[6, 7]
50% (non-preferred hospitals subject to maximum payment of $300/day)	50% (up to 100 days/ calendar year). If authorized, paid at Tier 2 - Blue Shield PPO.	50% (up to 100 days/ calendar year). If authorized, paid at Tier 2 - Blue Shield PPO; otherwise, subject to maximum payment of $300/ day.	50%	50%	50% (up to allowed amount and 24-visit limit/ calendar year combined with acupuncture)	30% (up to allowed amount and 24-visit limit/ calendar year combined with chiropractor)	50% (of billed charges per prescription)[8]	Not covered
30%	30% (up to 100 visits/ calendar year)	30% (up to 100 days/calendar year)	30%	No charge if part of a routine physical exam, otherwise 30%	30% (24-visit limit/calendar year combined with acupuncture)	30% (24-visit limit/ calendar year combined with chiropractor)	30%[8, 9]	30%[8]
Not covered unless prior authorized. If authorized, in-network benefit applies.	Not covered unless prior authorized. If authorized, in-network benefit applies.	Freestanding SNF: 50% Hospital Based SNF: 50% subject to a benefit maximum of $360/day (up to 100 days/calendar year)	50%	50%	50% (up to allowed amount and 24-visit limit/ calendar year combined with acupuncture)	30% (up to allowed amount and 24-visit limit/ calendar year combined with chiropractor)	50%[8]	Not covered

BEHAVIORAL HEALTH[10]

Mental Health Inpatient	Mental Health Outpatient Visits	Substance Use Inpatient	Substance Use Outpatient Visits
$250 copayment per admittance or course of treatment (preauthorization required)	Visits 1–3: No copayment Visits 4+: $30 (other outpatient services: $0 copay for 4+ visits)	$250 copayment per admittance or course of treatment (preauthorization required)	Visits 1–3: No copayment Visits 4+: $30 (other outpatient services: $0 copay for 4+ visits)
Kaiser: $250 copayment per admittance Optum: $250 copayment per admittance or course of treatment (preauthorization required)	Kaiser: $30 for individual visit; $15 for group visit. Optum: Visits 1–3: No copayment. Visits 4+: $30	Kaiser: $250 copayment per admittance Optum: $250 copayment per admittance or course of treatment (preauthorization required)	Kaiser: $30 for individual visit; $5 for group visit. Optum: Visits 1–3: No copayment. Visits 4+: $30
$250 copayment per admittance or course of treatment	Visits 1–3: No copayment Visits 4+: $30	$250 copayment per admittance or course of treatment	Visits 1–3: No copayment Visits 4+: $30
$250 copayment per admittance or course of treatment	Visits 1–3: No copayment Visits 4+: $30	$250 copayment per admittance or course of treatment	Visits 1–3: No copayment Visits 4+: $30
50% Additional $250 copayment for failure to preauthorize	50%	50% Additional $250 copayment for failure to preauthorize	50%
30%	30%	30%	30%
50%	50%	50%	50%

Note: Benefits show what member pays.

This is a summary only. Important details—such as limitations, exclusions, exceptions, and other qualifiers—may not be included. For detailed information, call the plan or see their website for specific benefits, benefits when traveling overseas, provider information, and plan booklets.

Service areas: To determine if a medical plan provides service where you live, call the plan directly.

For plan website links, visit ucal.us/plancontacts

Blue Shield of California is the medical plan administrator and Navitus is the pharmacy benefit manager of the UC Care and HealthSavings+ plans.

Health Net is the administrator of the UC Blue & Gold HMO plan.

[5] When a generic drug is available and you or your physician choose the brand name drug, the drug will not be covered by the plan. If you obtain a brand name drug in this scenario, you will be responsible for 100% of the cost and it will not count towards your annual out-of-pocket maximum. With prior authorization, exceptions for medical necessity can be made and you pay the non-formulary (Tier 3) copay.

[6] The Navitus prescription drug formulary classifies (and charges for) medications by tier, as follows:
Tier 1—Preferred generics and some lower cost brand products
Tier 2—Preferred brand products and some high cost non-preferred generics
Tier 3—Non-preferred products (could include some high cost non-preferred generics)

[7] When a generic drug is available and you or your physician choose the brand-name drug, you must pay the applicable brand copay plus the difference between the cost of the brand-name drug and the generic equivalent. With prior authorization, exceptions for medical necessity can be made and you pay the Tier 3 (Non-preferred) copay.

[8] When a generic drug is available and you or your physician choose the brand-name drug, you must pay coinsurance on the cost of the brand drug plus the difference between the cost of the brand-name drug and the generic equivalent. With prior authorization, exceptions for medical necessity can be made and you pay coinsurance on the cost of the brand-name drug.

[9] 90-day supply available for maintenance medication at UC Medical Center pharmacies at plan's mail order copay benefit level. UC Blue & Gold HMO plan members can access this benefit at CVS walk-up pharmacies. UC PPO plan members can also access this benefit at additional Navitus Preferred Retail Pharmacies.

[10] PPO members receive behavioral health benefits through their medical plan. UC Blue & Gold HMO members receive behavioral health benefits through Health Net Behavioral Health. Kaiser members have access to the Kaiser benefit shown, in addition to the Optum in-network benefits and network of providers.

[11] Note about out-of-network providers: In addition to any deductible and coinsurance, you are responsible for any billed charge that exceeds Blue Shield's maximum allowed amount for services. These additional amounts do not apply toward your out-of-pocket maximum.

By authority of The Regents, University of California Human Resources, located in Oakland, administers all benefit plans in accordance with applicable plan documents and regulations, custodial agreements, University of California Group Insurance Regulations, group insurance contracts, and state and federal laws. No person is authorized to provide benefits information not contained in these source documents, and information not contained in these source documents cannot be relied upon as having been authorized by The Regents. Source documents are available for inspection upon request (800-888-8267). What is written here does not constitute a guarantee of plan coverage or benefits — particular rules and eligibility requirements must be met before benefits can be received. The University of California intends to continue the benefits described here indefinitely; however, the benefits of all employees, retirees, and plan beneficiaries are subject to change or termination at the time of contract renewal or at any other time by the University or other governing authorities. The University also reserves the right to determine new premiums, employer contributions and monthly costs at any time. Health and welfare benefits are not accrued or vested benefit entitlements. UC's contribution toward the monthly cost of the coverage is determined by UC and may change or stop altogether, and may be affected by the state of California's annual budget appropriation. If you belong to an exclusively represented bargaining unit, some of your benefits may differ from the ones described here. For more information, employees should contact your Human Resources Office and retirees should call the UC Retirement Administration Service Center (800-888-8267).

The Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act of 1985 (COBRA) provides for continued coverage for a certain period of time at applicable monthly COBRA rates if you, your spouse, or your dependents lose group medical, dental, or vision coverage because you terminate employment (for reasons other than gross misconduct); your work hours are reduced below the eligible status for these benefits; you die, divorce, or are legally separated; or a child ceases to be an eligible dependent. Note: The continuation period is calculated from the earliest of these qualifying events and runs concurrently with any other UC options for continued coverage. See your Benefits Representative for more information.

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